



DANCE MUSIC

The viol was played with a bow, like a violin or viola. It was used mainly to accompany dances. In *Twelfth Night*, the foolish Sir Andrew Aguecheek "plays o' the viol-de-gamboys" in order to appear fashionable.

Pipes produced a single continuous note called a drone

Second drone pipe

Viol made in the 1600s

MYSTERIOUS MELODIES

The hautboy, or shawm, made an eerie, solemn sound, which Shakespeare used to create an atmosphere of dread in his tragedies. Hautboys were often played before ghosts appeared on the stage.

Hautboy

16th-century engraving by Crispin de Passe

Musician blew air through mouthpiece

Bag was made of leather

The tune was played with the fingers on this pipe

Bagpipe

LOVERS' LUTES

Lutes were often played by men when they were wooing women (trying to win their love). In *The Taming of the Shrew*, Petruchio tries to give hot-tempered Katherina a lute lesson. It ends with her smashing Petruchio over the head with his lute!

BAGPIPE BLUES

In Shakespeare's time, the bagpipe was a popular instrument in England. It was played mostly in the open air for country dances. Falstaff, in *Henry IV Part One*, says that he feels as melancholy as "the drone of a Lincolnshire bagpipe."

"Let the sounds of music creep in our ears"

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE
Lorenzo in *The Merchant of Venice*

SOOTHING SOUNDS

The lute was a stringed instrument that was plucked to produce light and delicate notes. Many people in Shakespeare's day believed that its sweet, soothing sound had the ability to heal. In *King Lear*, the mad king is brought to his senses with music – almost certainly played on a lute.

The sheep's gut strings were plucked with the fingers and thumb